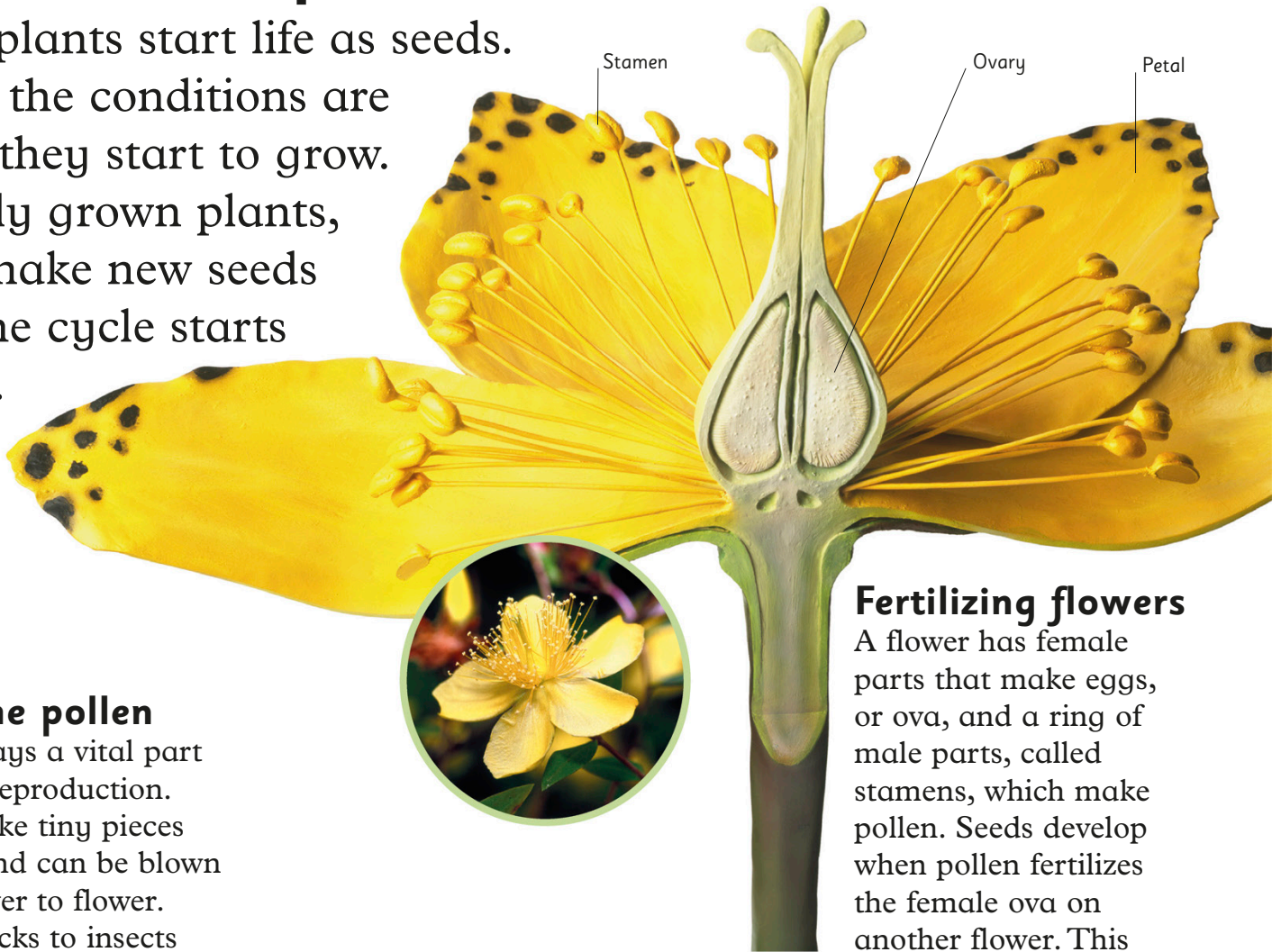


Plant reproduction

Most plants start life as seeds. When the conditions are right, they start to grow. As fully grown plants, they make new seeds and the cycle starts again.



Fertilizing flowers

A flower has female parts that make eggs, or ova, and a ring of male parts, called stamens, which make pollen. Seeds develop when pollen fertilizes the female ova on another flower. This is called pollination.



Pass the pollen

Pollen plays a vital part in plant reproduction. It looks like tiny pieces of dust and can be blown from flower to flower. It also sticks to insects and birds and gets flown to new flowers.



Waving in the wind

A catkin is the flower of the willow tree. In catkins, the male and female parts are on separate flowers. Catkins move in the wind and release a lot of pollen, which then pollinates the female flowers.



Bees carry pollen in sacs on their legs.